CLASS NOTES · TADABBUR SIRI 3

# Surah Al-Fatihah: *Ayat 2*

Al-hamdu lillahi Rabbil-'alamin | Praise, syukur, and who our Rabb really is

**IN SHORT**

- All praise is Allah's — He doesn't need it; it trains our hearts.
- Syukur has three levels: heart, tongue, and using the nikmat in obedience.
- Rabb = Creator, Owner and Manager of everything.

## *1.* Text & meaning

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

*"Segala puji bagi Allah, Tuhan sekalian alam."*

**WORD BY WORD**

**2**

| الْحَمْدُ | لِلَّهِ | رَبِّ | الْعَالَمِينَ |
|---|---|---|---|
| segala puji | bagi Allah | Tuhan | sekalian alam |

*Segala puji bagi Allah, Tuhan sekalian alam.*

## *2.* Why does the surah open with praise?

1. Allah is the **Creator, Owner and Manager** of the whole universe.
2. Allah is **teaching us** how to praise Him properly.
3. Allah is **Al-Ghaniy** — He doesn't need our praise. Our praise adds nothing to His kingdom; our criticism takes nothing from His power.

> So the praise in our solat isn't for **Allah's benefit** — it's to train **our hearts.**

**EXCESSIVE PRAISE OF PEOPLE IS FORBIDDEN**

Al-Miqdad bin al-Aswad r.a. narrated that the Prophet ﷺ told us to **throw dust in the faces of those who over-praise** (Muslim 3002) — a strong rebuke of praise that can ruin the person being praised.

لَا يَدْخُلُ الْجَنَّةَ مَنْ كَانَ فِي قَلْبِهِ مِثْقَالُ ذَرَّةٍ مِنْ كِبْرٍ

*"Tidak akan masuk syurga orang yang di dalam hatinya terdapat sebesar zarah daripada kesombongan."*

MUSLIM 91 · SAHIH

**Zarah** = something tiny, like the fine dust you see floating when sunlight comes through a gap in the window.

## 3. The three levels of syukur

| | LEVEL | MEANING |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Syukur dengan **hati** | Fully acknowledging that every nikmat comes from Allah |
| 2 | Syukur dengan **lisan** | Mentioning and praising Allah for it — Ad-Dhuha 93:11 |
| 3 | Syukur dengan **anggota badan** | Using the nikmat to obey Him |

**Level 3 in action:** the Prophet ﷺ prayed at night until **his feet swelled.** Aisyah r.a. asked why, when his sins were already forgiven. He said: *"Tidakkah aku mahu menjadi hamba yang bersyukur?"* (Bukhari 4837; Muslim 2819)

Syukur by the tongue, from Nabi Sulaiman a.s.: *"Ini adalah daripada kurniaan Tuhanku"* — An-Naml 27:40.

## 4. When do we praise Allah?

In **every** state. The Prophet ﷺ had a **pair** of phrases:

| SITUATION | SAY |
|---|---|
| Something you like / a nikmat | اَلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي بِنِعْمَتِهِ تَتِمُّ الصَّالِحَاتُ<br>*"Segala puji bagi Allah yang dengan nikmat-Nya sempurnalah segala kebaikan."* |
| Something you dislike | اَلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ حَالٍ<br>*"Segala puji bagi Allah dalam setiap keadaan."* |

IBN MAJAH 3803 (AISYAH) · HASAN — GRADED DIFFERENTLY BY SCHOLARS, STRENGTHENED BY SUPPORTING CHAINS (AL-HAKIM, AL-ALBANI)

*Note: this is a **pair**, not one du'a — many infographics only show half. For a real musibah, the stronger dalil is* innā lillāhi wa innā ilaihi rāji'ūn *(Muslim 918).*

فَاذْكُرُونِي أَذْكُرْكُمْ وَاشْكُرُوا لِي وَلَا تَكْفُرُونِ

*"Maka ingatlah kamu kepada-Ku, nescaya Aku ingat kepada kamu; dan bersyukurlah kepada-Ku, dan janganlah kamu kufur."*

AL-BAQARAH 2:152

- **"Ingat Allah"** = always aware Allah is there — zikir, du'a, solat, doing good for His sake.
- **"Allah ingat kamu"** = He gives His attention, rahmat, help and good reward.
- **"Bersyukur"** = valuing His nikmat — not just saying Alhamdulillah, but using it for the right things.
- **"Jangan kufur"** = don't pretend not to see the nikmat — forgetting Allah, endless complaining, using it for sin, or thinking every success comes from yourself.

#### WHY IS IT HARD TO PRAISE ALLAH IN HARDSHIP?

Because we see musibah with a **narrow view** and don't know the hikmah behind it. Nabi Khidir a.s. damaged a boat (Al-Kahf 18:79) — what looked like a disaster was actually what **saved** it from a king who seized every good boat.

> عَجَبًا لِأَمْرِ الْمُؤْمِنِ، إِنَّ أَمْرَهُ كُلَّهُ خَيْرٌ
>
> *"Menakjubkan urusan orang beriman — semua urusannya baik baginya." Senang → bersyukur → baik baginya. Susah → bersabar → baik baginya.*
>
> MUSLIM 2999 (SUHAIB) · SAHIH

Its pair of warnings — **Ibrahim 14:7**: be grateful and I'll increase you; be ungrateful and My punishment is severe.

## 5. What does "Rabb" mean?

| NAME | MEANING |
|---|---|
| **Al-Khaliq** (الخالق) | Creator |
| **Al-Malik** (المالك) | Owner |
| **Al-Mudabbir** (المدبر) | Manager and Administrator of all the worlds |

No one else creates, owns **and** runs the universe. All three meet only in Him — this is the argument of tauhid rububiyyah.

## 6. What does "Al-'Alamin" mean?

From **الْعَالَم** — "something that serves as a sign". Every creation is a **sign** pointing to Allah's greatness, power and perfection.

| LOOK | DALIL | CONTENT |
|---|---|---|
| **Up — the sky** | Qaf 50:6 | The sky built without a single crack |
| **Down — a mosquito** | Al-Baqarah 2:26 | Allah isn't shy to give the example of a mosquito, or something smaller |

Even a mosquito: a tiny needle, finds you in the dark, detects the right blood, we're scared of it despite its size, and it can carry diseases that kill.

> Allah's greatness shows in the **vast** and in the **tiny** — both are signs leading us to know *Rabbil-'alamin*.

## Reflections

- **Syukur has three levels, and most of us stop at two.** We acknowledge it in the heart and say Alhamdulillah — but level three, actually using the nikmat in obedience, is the one that takes effort and real decisions.
- **If Allah is Al-Malik, we don't truly own anything.** What we call "mine" is held on trust, with conditions.
- **Muslim 2999 moves the measure from outcome to response.** Gain or loss can both be good for a believer — what's judged is our sabar and syukur, not the numbers.

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Personal notes from the Tadabbur class (Siri 3), compiled for revision and sharing. All ayat and hadith checked against quran.com, sunnah.com and dorar.net. Any mistakes are mine — please tegur. والله أعلم